

UMESH GAUTAM

Department of Agricultural & Applied Economics | Texas Tech University | Lubbock, TX

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RESEARCH FIELDS

International Trade | Industrial Organization | Production Economics | Immigration Policy

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Applied Economics, <i>Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX</i>	Expected Spring 2027
M.S. in Applied Economics, <i>Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX</i>	Expected Fall 2026
M.A. in Economics, <i>Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX</i>	2022
Bachelor of Business Administration, <i>Kathmandu University, Nepal</i>	2017

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

GRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX

Fall 2022-Present

Research Assistant to Prof. Dr. Stephen Devadoss

Assisted in developing research papers, replicating empirical analyses, and deriving theoretical models in international trade, industrial organization, causal inference, and public policy.

PUBLICATIONS

Devadoss, S., and U. Gautam.* ***Implications of Mass Deportation for US Vegetable Production.***
Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics 51(3): 1–17, 2026. DOI: 10.22004/ag.econ.376283.

Gautam, U., and S. Devadoss. ***Impacts of Deportation on Employment, Wages, and Output in California Vegetable Production.*** Applied Economics Education and Extension, Applied Economic Insights 8(2), 2026. DOI: 10.71162/aeec.358040.

* Authorship is shared equally.

MANUSCRIPT SUBMITTED

Gautam, U., and S. Devadoss. ***Implications of Stricter Immigration Policies for US Fruit Production.***
Submitted to Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics, 2026.

Examines the long-run effects of stricter U.S. immigration enforcement on fruit production, focusing on how changes in undocumented labor availability affect wages, employment, and output, and the extent to which labor- and capital-augmenting technological progress can mitigate output losses.

JOB MARKET PAPER

Gautam, U., and S. Devadoss. *A Structural Gravity Analysis of Trade Under Imperfect Competition: Evidence from the Global Tree-Nut Market.*

Global tree-nut markets are concentrated among a relatively small number of major suppliers, creating scope for oligopoly power in international trade. This paper incorporates market power into a structural gravity model, assuming a single firm in each country with multiproduct ownership. It evaluates three forms of market conduct—perfect competition, Bertrand competition, and Cournot competition—comparing model-implied trade shares with observed trade shares. We find that the Cournot model best fits the data. Free-trade counterfactuals show meaningful differences in global and U.S. trade reallocation and welfare changes across conduct assumptions. Model-fit and counterfactual results are robust to increasing the number of firms beyond the single-firm benchmark.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Gautam, U., and S. Devadoss. *Why Is Healthcare So Expensive in the U.S.?*

Gautam, U., W. Blundell, S. Devadoss, and J. Luckstead. *Effects of Mergers and Acquisitions on Retail Prices.*

Examines the effects of mergers and acquisitions on retail prices using product-level data and staggered difference-in-differences.

Gautam, U., and S. Devadoss. *Implications of Tariff Policies in the U.S. Automobile Industry.*

Examines the effects of tariff policies on firm profitability and overall welfare in an automobile industry characterized by oligopolistic competition.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Part-Time Instructor – AAEC 2305 – Fundamentals of Agricultural and Applied Economics	Expected Spring 2027
Graduate Part-Time Instructor – AAEC 2305 – Fundamentals of Agricultural and Applied Economics	Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant – AAEC 6315 – Applied Microeconomics I (Ph.D.)	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant – AAEC 6315 – Applied Microeconomics I (Ph.D.)	Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant – ECO 3311 – Intermediate Macroeconomics	Fall 2021
Teaching Assistant – ECO 5314 – Econometrics	Fall 2020
Teaching Assistant – ECO 2305 – Principles of Economics	Spring 2020
Teaching Assistant – ECO 2305 – Principles of Economics	Fall 2019

TECHNICAL SKILLS

R | Stata | Python | LaTeX/LyX

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

<i>Implications of Stricter Immigration Enforcement for US Fruit Production.</i>	
Western Agricultural Economics Association (WAEA) Annual Meeting, Flagstaff, Arizona	June 2026
<i>Implications of Mass Deportation for U.S. Vegetable Production.</i>	
Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA) Annual Meeting, Louisville, Kentucky	February 2026
<i>Implications of Mass Deportation for U.S. Vegetable Production.</i>	
Three Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition, Texas Tech University	October 2025
<i>Implications of Mass Deportation for U.S. Vegetable Production.</i>	
Davis College Poster Competition, Texas Tech University	October 2025

HONORS & AWARDS

Bloom Award, Spring into Discovery Research Slam Competition, Texas Tech University.	April 2026
<i>Consequences of Stricter Immigration Enforcement for U.S. Vegetable Production.</i>	
Summer Thesis/Dissertation Research Award, Texas Tech University	2025
Graduate Student Mentor, Davis College Gordon and Joyce Davis Endowed Scholarship	2025
Graduate Student Mentor, Davis College Gordon and Joyce Davis Endowed Scholarship	2024
Study Abroad Competitive Scholarship	2020
Global Commitment Award, Global Enterprise Experience, New Zealand	2015
Winner, Advertisement Competition, Kathmandu	2017
First Runner-up, National Management Festival, Kathmandu	2016

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Session Moderator, “Labor, Automation, and Migration,” Western Agricultural Economics Association Annual Meeting, Flagstaff, Arizona	June 2026
Coordinator, Kathmandu University Annual Co-Curricular Events	2016
Organizer, Kathmandu University Annual Co-Curricular Events	2014
Organizer, KUSOM Annual Festival, Kathmandu University	2014–2016

VOLUNTEER SERVICE

Volunteer, Eco-Carnival, Kathmandu University	2013–2015
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REFERENCES

Dr. Stephen Devadoss

Emabeth Thompson Endowed Professor | Department of Agricultural & Applied Economics, Texas Tech University | stephen.devadoss@ttu.edu

Dr. Benaissa Chidmi

Associate Professor | Department of Agricultural & Applied Economics, Texas Tech University | benaissa.chidmi@ttu.edu

Dr. Michael Noel

Professor | Department of Economics, Texas Tech University | michael.noel@ttu.edu